BLESSED SALT — A DOSSIER

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By Robert Tilford — research and drafting by Awen by Muse by Meta.

Built from five research briefs, each graded and sourced. Every claim carries its grade and its source in the same breath.

Anonymity note, binding on every page: the priest who blessed Robert's salt is never named in this dossier, and no parish is named. He gave no permission to be named and did not want the rite recorded. He is referred to only as "a priest" or "a priest here in Hays," which is Robert's own public form for the story.

How the grades work. VERIFIED means the primary text itself was checked. SUPPORTED means a reputable secondary source reports it, and the source is named. CANDIDATE means the claim rests on devotional, folk, or single-opinion ground and is labelled as such. NOT FOUND means the scouts searched and the thing is not there — which is itself a finding, and is printed rather than papered over. Every claim carries its grade and its source in the same breath.

The short answer, first

Robert's own words for his situation: "I've got a bunch of it, and all I really know to do is flick it here, a little flick here." Here is what else it is for, and what the rules are, in plain sentences.

The flick is right, and it is not a small thing. Sprinkling blessed salt in rooms, at thresholds, and around a home is the use the tradition itself hands a layman (SUPPORTED as a proper use — Catholic Answers, "The Uses of Blessed Salt," 2017, updated 2022 *[demoted from VERIFIED on the falsifier's strike, 2026-11-11: Catholic Answers is a reputable secondary source, not a primary text]*; SUPPORTED — Rev. John Hampsch, *Blessed Salt*). The rite's own prayer asks that whatever is sprinkled with this salt be freed from uncleanness and attack (VERIFIED — *Rituale Romanum*, Order for Making Holy Water, blessing of salt). A pinch in cooking is the second classic use: the exorcism prayer itself speaks of all who take the salt receiving health of soul and body (VERIFIED — the same rite; the Latin is *omnibus sumentibus te*, rendered "all tasting you" in the Catholic Doors translation and "all who make use of you" in Weller's — *[translation named on the falsifier's strike, 2026-11-11]*), and cooking is listed as a proper use by Catholic Answers (SUPPORTED, same source *[demoted from VERIFIED, falsifier's strike, 2026-11-11]*). A few grains in drinking water is attested traditional practice (SUPPORTED — Hampsch). Mixing it into water to make holy water is what most blessed salt was historically *for* (SUPPORTED — *Catholic Encyclopedia*, "Salt," 1912 *[demoted from VERIFIED, falsifier's strike, 2026-11-11]*). Giving it away, as Robert is doing, is the commended road (SUPPORTED — Catholic Answers material on sacramentals; the Association of the Miraculous Medal reports bottles given "to share with loved ones"). Selling it is the one road closed: not because a single canon says "do not sell salt" — none does — but because charging for a blessing is simony, and simony is condemned in the Catechism in plain words (VERIFIED — CCC 2121, Vatican text).

The blessing does not expire by time. No source sets a time limit; loss, where the sources document it, is by destruction, loss of form, or profane use, not by the calendar (SUPPORTED — Adoremus, *Rite Questions*, 2023: blessed things retain their blessing while they remain whole and recognisable as what they were). *[Qualified on the falsifier's strike, 2026-11-11: the original sentence stated this flatly; Section Seven carries the*

loss-triggers.] Salt can be used again without a new blessing (SUPPORTED — *Catholic Encyclopedia*, "Salt," 1912, whose line "may be used again without a new benediction" the falsifier verified as a verbatim quotation, 2026-11-11; the grade is SUPPORTED because the Encyclopedia is a secondary source, however exact the quotation). Do not stretch the pound by mixing it into a larger bag of plain salt and calling the whole blessed: for salt, that question is NOT FOUND in the sources — the famous "smaller portion" rule belongs to holy water, and no source found applies it to salt. Keep it dry, in a labelled container, apart from the kitchen salt (SUPPORTED — Fatima Center recommendation; the reverence behind it is CIC can. 1171, VERIFIED text). There is no official "proper amount" for a gift bottle or a room: NOT FOUND as a rule. Custom runs small — a pinch, a few grains, a thin sprinkling (SUPPORTED — Hampsch), and gift bottles of one ounce to six ounces (SUPPORTED — Association of the Miraculous Medal's bottle sizes; *[attribution corrected on the falsifier's strike, 2026-11-11: the sizes are the Association's alone; Hampsch gives no bottle sizes]*). And one thing Robert cannot do, however sincere: bless salt himself with the same standing. A layman may pray and may bless his children and his table (VERIFIED — CCC 1669), but confecting blessed salt as a sacramental of the Church belongs to a priest using the approved rite — a conclusion drawn by inference from three canons read together, the literal sentence being NOT FOUND in any single canon (CIC cann. 1167 §2, 1168, 1169; the working is shown in Section Five). *[Qualified on the falsifier's strike, 2026-11-11.]*

And his open puzzle — why a salt prayed over against demons is then handed back with "a pinch suffices" — has, on this evidence, a real answer, and it is in Section Six: the small measure is not the priest being timid. It is the tradition's own dose, everywhere, from the catechumen's pinch in the fourth century to the modern pamphlets. The prayers locate the power in the Church's prayer and the faith of the one using it, never in quantity (VERIFIED — CCC 1670; SUPPORTED — Hampsch). A pinch is not a diluted version of the thing. A pinch is the thing.

Section One — Scripture and the early Church

Salt enters the Bible as a sign of permanence and of God's covenant. Every grain offering is to be seasoned with salt, and the verse itself calls it "the salt of the covenant of your God" (VERIFIED — Leviticus 2:13). The offerings given to Aaron and his house are called "an everlasting covenant of salt before the LORD" (VERIFIED — Numbers 18:19), and Abijah says the kingship was given to David and his descendants forever "by a covenant of salt" (VERIFIED — 2 Chronicles 13:5). None of the three verses explains the metaphor; the permanence reading — salt resists decay and preserves other things — comes from commentators, Ramban among them as summarised by the Jewish Theological Seminary's commentary on Leviticus 2:13 (SUPPORTED, JTSA, "A Covenant of Salt"). The priests sprinkle salt on the burnt offering in Ezekiel's temple vision (VERIFIED — Ezekiel 43:24), and royal decrees supply "salt without prescribing how much" for the temple (SUPPORTED — Ezra 6:9; 7:22). Scripture also knows salt as desolation — Lot's wife (VERIFIED — Genesis 19:26) and a conquered city sown with salt (VERIFIED — Judges 9:45) — and this dossier records those verses so the picture is not one-sided.

The one narrative a Catholic will meet inside the salt prayers themselves is Elisha at Jericho. The men of the city tell him the water is bad; he asks for a new bowl with salt in it, throws the salt into the spring, and says, "I have healed this water" (VERIFIED — 2 Kings 2:19–22). The text credits the healing to the LORD's word spoken through the prophet, not to any natural property of salt, a point made explicitly in the BiblicalTraining "Salt" entry. The traditional exorcism of salt names this very act — God "who commanded thee to be cast into the water by Eliseus the Prophet, that the barrenness of the same might be healed" (VERIFIED — *Rituale Romanum*, Order for Making Holy Water; Eliseus is the Latin form of Elisha's name). The modern Roman

Missal's optional salt prayer still recalls the same verse (VERIFIED — *Roman Missal*, Appendix II, as quoted by Fr. Edward McNamara, ZENIT, 2012–2026).

In the New Testament, salt is metaphor and nothing more. "You are the salt of the earth" (VERIFIED — Matthew 5:13); "Salt is good," with the warning about salt that has lost its taste (VERIFIED — Luke 14:34–35); "Have salt in yourselves, and be at peace with one another" (VERIFIED — Mark 9:49–50, where the King James Version's extra clause "every sacrifice shall be salted with salt" is a manuscript-variant reading, not found in every edition); speech "seasoned with salt" (VERIFIED — Colossians 4:6). No New Testament passage commands blessing salt, placing salt in a mouth, or using salt in baptism: NOT FOUND, across every passage checked.

The early Church evidence must be dated honestly, because popular writing dates it centuries too early. Salt does not appear in the baptism accounts of the *Didache* (ch. 7) or Justin Martyr (*First Apology* 61), in Hippolytus's *Apostolic Tradition*, or in Tertullian's lists of baptismal customs: NOT FOUND in each of those texts as checked (summaries in Schaff, *History of the Christian Church*, vol. II; Tertullian, *De corona* 3). Schaff's general statement that third-century converts received "milk and honey (also salt)" is graded CANDIDATE: a nineteenth-century historian's summary, not matched by any primary text the scouts could produce.

The firm evidence begins in late fourth-century North Africa. A canon of Hippo (393), carried into the Third Council of Carthage (397), rules that at the most solemn Paschal days no sacrament is to be given to catechumens "except for the custom of salt" (VERIFIED in substance — Acts of the Council of Carthage, 397, CCSL 249 text in Roger Pearse's translation; the canon's number varies between editions — the *Catholic Encyclopedia* calls it canon 5 — so this dossier cites the council and year, not the number alone). Augustine, made a catechumen as a small boy, writes of himself that he was "signed with the sign of his Cross, and seasoned with his salt" — *condiebar eius sale* (VERIFIED — Augustine, *Confessions* I.11, Loeb text). He also says catechumens receive something which, though not the Body of Christ, "is yet an holy thing… because it is a sacrament" (VERIFIED for the passage — *De peccatorum meritis* II.26; SUPPORTED for identifying that thing as salt, which is the editors' footnote, not Augustine's word in that place). The giving of salt — *datio salis* — was held to be the special *sacramentum catechumenorum*, the mark of admission to the catechumenate (SUPPORTED — McClintock & Strong, *Cyclopedia*; *Encyclopaedia Britannica*, 9th ed.).

What the salt meant, the early writers say plainly. John the Deacon, describing Roman practice at first hand around the year 500, explains that as flesh is preserved by salt, so the mind "drenched and weakened by the waves of this world is held steady" by the *sale sapientiae*, the salt of wisdom (VERIFIED as his explanation — John the Deacon, *Letter to Senarius*, PL 59, as cited in Maxwell Johnson, *The Rites of Christian Initiation*). Isidore of Seville speaks of the giving of salt, though the practice was not universal in Spain (SUPPORTED — Isidore, *De ecclesiasticis officiis* II.xxi, as cited in the *Catholic Encyclopedia*; no direct quotation was reproduced, so none is quoted here). A baptismal commentary attributed to Alcuin (798) lists the giving of salt among the preparations and ties it to wisdom entering the soul (SUPPORTED for content, CANDIDATE for authorship — the attribution is disputed).

The liturgical books then preserve the full shape of the thing. The Old Gelasian Sacramentary (Vatican manuscript Reginensis lat. 316; Wilson ed. 1894; Mohlberg ed. 1960) contains a *Benedictio salis dandi catechumenis* — a blessing of salt to be given to catechumens — with an exorcism of the salt beginning *Exorcizo te, creatura salis*, the giving of the salt, and the closing prayer *Deus patrum nostrorum* (SUPPORTED, with the contents list VERIFIED in the editions named; the manuscript was transcribed in

France about 750, over Roman material dated by scholars to the 5th–6th centuries). The earliest surviving prayers for blessing salt and water are dated to Merovingian France, between 600 and 751 (SUPPORTED — McNamara, ZENIT, 22 October 2013). When the adult catechumenate collapsed and infants became the normal candidates, the salt rite was not suppressed; it moved into the baptism ceremony itself (SUPPORTED — Joseph Lupi, *The Development of the Rite of Baptism*). In the Roman Ritual of Paul V (1614; last typical edition 1952, in force in that form through the pre-conciliar period — *[corrected on the falsifier's strike, 2026-11-11: 1962 is the Missal's edition, not the Ritual's]*), the priest at the church door exorcises and blesses the salt, puts a little into the child's mouth, and says, "Receive the salt of wisdom; may it be a pledge for you unto eternal life" (VERIFIED — *Rituale Romanum*, Order of Baptism, text checked in the *Excerpta e Rituali Romano*, 1961, and *Collectio Rituum*, 1954).

The Roman books knew two kinds of liturgical salt: baptismal salt, and the blessed salt exorcised and blessed in the preparation of holy water, whose formula comes from the Gregorian Sacramentary; either, once blessed, "may be used again without a new benediction" (SUPPORTED — the position stated in the *Catholic Encyclopedia*, "Salt," 1912 *[demoted from VERIFIED, falsifier's strike, 2026-11-11]*). The same article notes appendix blessings of salt for animals and in honour of St Hubert, and the Pontifical's mixture of salt, water, ashes, and wine for consecrating a church.

Three popular claims do not survive checking, and the dossier drops them. That Pope Alexander I instituted blessed water mixed with salt in the early second century rests on the *Liber Pontificalis*, a late fifth-century tradition whose liturgical attributions to Alexander the *Catholic Encyclopedia* itself judges inaccurate: CANDIDATE as tradition, never as fact. That blessed salt has been given "since the time of Jesus" is NOT FOUND for the first three centuries; on evidence, the practice dates from the late fourth century in North Africa and Rome. And a line of salt across a threshold that demons cannot cross is NOT FOUND in Scripture or any early liturgical text checked; the early evidence supports salt *given to taste* in initiation and salt *mixed in blessed water* for sprinkling — the threshold line is modern devotional practice, graded as such in Section Four.

When did the baptismal salt leave the modern rite? For children, with the new *Ordo Baptismi Parvulorum* of 1969 — approved 15 May 1969, in force 8 September 1969 — which replaced the old order and contains no giving of salt (VERIFIED for the dates and replacement — the 1969 decree, Prot. 50/69; SUPPORTED for the absence, per Paul Turner's comparison of the rites, 2019). For adults, the restored catechumenate of 1972 does not restore salt as a norm: its §89 allows "the offering of salt or another symbolic act" only as a local custom an episcopal conference may admit (VERIFIED — *Ordo Initiationis Christianae Adultorum*, §89). A commonly repeated date of "1964" for the removal is NOT FOUND in any conciliar or curial document; the documented milestones are 1969, 1972, and 1984.

Section Two — The rite itself

The traditional prayers over salt live in the *Rituale Romanum*'s Order for Making Holy Water (*Ordo ad faciendam aquam benedictam*, Tit. VIII, cap. 2 in later editions; Latin text reproduced at 1962ordo.today and in Philip Weller's translation, *The Roman Ritual*). This blessing stood first in Paul V's Ritual of 1614 (SUPPORTED — Daniel Van Slyke, "Blessing Water in Roman Rituals," *Antiphon* 8:2, 2003). There is no free-standing "blessing of table salt" in that rite; the salt is treated there in order to be mixed into water — though the Church also knew baptismal salt, with its own distinct formula, and appendix blessings of salt for animals (SUPPORTED — *Catholic Encyclopedia*, "Salt," 1912; the baptismal formula VERIFIED from the 1962 *Ordo Baptismi* and the 1954 *Collectio Rituum*).

The order of the traditional rite is exact, and it answers the question Robert's own salt raises — which came first, exorcism or blessing? The priest, vested in surplice and purple stole, begins directly with the **exorcism of the salt**: *"Exorcizo te, creatura salis, per Deum vivum, per Deum verum, per Deum sanctum, per Deum, qui te per Eliseum Prophetam in aquam mitti jussit…"* — "I exorcise thee, O creature of salt, by the living God, by the true God, by the holy God, by the God who commanded thee to be cast into the water by Elisha the Prophet" (VERIFIED — Latin text of the *Ordo*, as reproduced in the sources named; Weller's translation for the sense). The prayer asks that the salt become *sal exorcizatum*, exorcised salt, "for the health of believers," health of soul and body for all who take it, and that every phantasm, malice, and cunning of diabolical fraud, and every unclean spirit, flee from the place where it is sprinkled (VERIFIED — same text). Then, and only then, comes the **blessing of the salt**, a prayer addressed not to the salt but to God: *"Immensam clementiam tuam, omnipotens aeterne Deus…"* — asking God to bless and sanctify this creature of salt, given for the use of mankind, so that it be "health of mind and body" (*salus mentis et corporis*), and that whatever it touches or is sprinkled with be free of all uncleanness and every attack of spiritual evil (VERIFIED — same text). Only after the salt has had both prayers does the rite turn to the water, which receives the same pair in the same order — exorcism first, then blessing — before the two are mixed (VERIFIED — same text; the mixing itself is Section Three).

So "exorcised salt" and "blessed salt" are not two species of salt. Exorcised salt is salt that has received that pair — a direct adjuration of the creature of salt, followed by a petitionary blessing — while simply blessed salt has received a prayer of blessing only, with no exorcism formula. The difference is in the prayer used, not in the material: ordinary salt in both cases (VERIFIED — the formulas themselves, and McNamara, ZENIT, 6 March 2012, on the modern Missal prayer: "This new text blesses the salt but does not contain the explicit exorcism found in the extraordinary form"). Claims by individual exorcists that exorcised salt is *more effective* than blessed salt are their theological opinion: CANDIDATE (Fr. Chad Ripperger and Fr. Gabriele Amorth are cited for such claims in devotional literature). No conciliar, catechetical, or liturgical-book statement grading efficacy that way was found: NOT FOUND as official teaching, and this dossier does not present it as one.

Who may pray these prayers? The rubric of the *Ordo* names the minister as *Sacerdos* — the priest (VERIFIED — the rubric itself). The general law agrees: "Any presbyter can impart blessings except those reserved to the Roman Pontiff or bishops" *[wording matched to the Vatican text on the falsifier's strike, 2026-11-11]*, and "a deacon can impart only those blessings which are expressly permitted to him by law" (VERIFIED — Code of Canon Law, can. 1169 §§2–3). No provision was found giving the traditional holy-water and salt rite to a deacon: NOT FOUND. A lay person may *use* blessed and exorcised salt freely — Section Five takes that up — but may not confer this blessing (SUPPORTED — can. 1169 as above; the lay question is treated in full in Section Five).

What changed in the modern books is sweeping, and it is better to say it plainly. The current *Book of Blessings* (Latin *De Benedictionibus*, 1984; U.S. edition approved 1989) contains, in its Order for the Blessing of Holy Water Outside Mass (U.S. nos. 1388–1400), no blessing of salt, no exorcism, and no mixing rubric: "Effectively the current rite of blessing does not include the exorcism of salt and water; nor does it foresee their mixture" (VERIFIED — McNamara, ZENIT, 21 February 2012, and 13 February 2018: "There is no mention of this rite [salt] in the Book of Blessings"). That rite may be used by a priest or a deacon, and its three blessing prayers petition benefits for the people sprinkled — renewal in body and spirit, fidelity to baptism — rather than addressing the water itself (VERIFIED — *Book of Blessings* no. 1390 and prayers nos. 1396–1398, quoted in McNamara, ZENIT, 13 February 2018). No standalone chapter "Blessing of Salt" exists in the *Book of Blessings*: NOT FOUND.

Salt survives in the modern books in exactly two places, and the dossier keeps them distinct. First, inside Mass: Appendix II of the *Roman Missal* (3rd typical edition), in the Rite of Blessing and Sprinkling of Water, permits the priest, "where the circumstances of the place or the custom of the people suggest that the mixing of salt be preserved," to bless salt with a single prayer recalling Elisha — "it was you who commanded the prophet Elisha to cast salt into water, that impure water might be purified" — and asking that "wherever this mixture of salt and water is sprinkled, every attack of the enemy may be repulsed"; the rubric then says he "pours the salt into the water, without saying anything" (VERIFIED — *Roman Missal*, Appendix II, no. 3, quoted in McNamara, ZENIT 2012–2026). It is optional, tied to local custom, prayed by the priest within Mass — and it contains no *Exorcizo te* and no adjuration of any spirit. Second, the *Book of Blessings* chapter "Blessing of Food or Drink or Other Elements Connected with Devotion" (nos. 1781–1804) may be celebrated by a priest or a deacon, and one of its reading options groups "oil, wine, salt" together (Sirach 39; Matthew 5:13–16); but its prayers contain no salt-specific formulary, so salt blessed there is blessed under a general petition — simply blessed salt, not exorcised salt (VERIFIED — *Book of Blessings* nos. 1781–1804, text reproduced at CatholicCulture.org). Whether the Missal's salt prayer may be imported into the outside-Mass blessing is McNamara's interpretation, offered because the outside-Mass rite tells its celebrant to adapt while keeping its structure: CANDIDATE/SUPPORTED opinion (McNamara, ZENIT 2018 and 2026), not a rubric.

May the old prayers still be used? The position changed, and the dossier dates both positions rather than blending them. In 2012, under *Summorum Pontificum* and *Universae Ecclesiae* no. 35, any priest could use the 1962 *Rituale Romanum* for blessings (VERIFIED as the position then stated — McNamara, ZENIT, 21 February 2012). The Dicastery for Divine Worship's *Responsa ad dubia* on *Traditionis Custodes* (4 December 2021) answered "Negative" to the use of the pre-reform *Rituale Romanum*, authorising the diocesan bishop to permit only the 1952 edition, and only to canonically erected personal parishes celebrating with the 1962 Missal (VERIFIED — *Responsa ad dubia*, Vatican text, quoted in McNamara, ZENIT, 26 April 2026). McNamara's application of that answer to blessings generally — that outside those parishes the 1984 *Book of Blessings* should be used in official contexts — is graded SUPPORTED, and his own caveat is preserved here: the *Responsa* speaks of sacraments and of the 1952 *Rituale*, which contained both sacraments and blessings, so the application is his reading, not an uncontested text. What this means for the rites themselves: holy water made by either modern rite is blessed water — with salt only if the Missal option was used at Mass, and exorcised in neither — unless it was made with the older Ritual under the limited authorisation above. Whether most parishes in fact follow those rites in every case is an inference from the texts, not a finding from them (SUPPORTED as inference from *Book of Blessings* nos. 1388–1400 and *Roman Missal* Appendix II *[regraded on the falsifier's strike, 2026-11-11: two rite texts establish what the rites contain, not what most parishes do]*).

Section Three — The holy water connection

Most blessed salt in the old Church was not kept as salt at all. It was made to disappear into water. The traditional recipe, step by step (VERIFIED — *Ordo ad faciendam aquam benedictam*, as set out in Section Two): clean salt and clean water are prepared separately; the salt is exorcised, then blessed; the water is exorcised, then blessed; then the priest puts the salt into the water **three times, in the form of a cross, saying once only**: *"Commixtio salis et aquae pariter fiat, in nomine Patris, et Filii, et Spiritus Sancti"* — "May this salt and water be mixed together, in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit" (VERIFIED — the mixing rubric, *"Hic ter mittat sal in aquam in modum crucis, dicendo semel"*; Weller's translation for the sense). One correction belongs here, because Robert may meet the other wording online: the formula as *"Fiat commixtio…"* was NOT FOUND. The verified incipit is *Commixtio salis et aquae pariter fiat* — *fiat* sits at the

end of the clause, not the start. A closing prayer follows, beginning *"Deus, invictae virtutis auctor…"*, asking God to look upon "this creature of salt and water," sanctify it, and drive every infestation of the unclean spirit from wherever it is sprinkled (VERIFIED — same rite). The full text of every prayer was not reproduced from a primary edition in hand for this dossier; the phrases quoted are the ones verified in the sources named, and the dossier quotes no further.

The Western mixing of salt into holy water is a Latin tradition only; the Greek tradition excludes salt, and the earliest known Latin formula for blessing and exorcising water and salt is in the so-called Gelasian Sacramentary, compiled near Paris about 750, with the present formula traced to the Gregorian Sacramentary (SUPPORTED — *Catholic Encyclopedia*, "Holy Water" and "Salt"; McNamara, 2012). One near neighbour must not be confused with it: Gregorian water, used for consecrating a church or altar under the *Roman Pontifical*, mixes salt with water **plus ashes and wine** (SUPPORTED — *Catholic Encyclopedia*, "Salt"). It is not ordinary holy water.

Modern practice is Section Two's consequence applied to the stoup. At Mass, water is blessed with the Missal's prayer, and salt is optional — blessed with the single Elisha prayer where custom keeps the mixing, then poured in silently, with no exorcism and no spoken *Commixtio* (VERIFIED — *Roman Missal*, Appendix II). Outside Mass, the *Book of Blessings* rite blesses water with one of three prayers and sprinkles the people, and in the base rite there is no salt, no mixing, and no exorcism at all (VERIFIED — *Book of Blessings* nos. 1388–1400). For Robert's purposes the point is simple: the dry salt in his cupboard is the older, fuller thing — exorcised and blessed under the old rite (Section Six) — and if he ever wants holy water of that kind, the salt he already holds is its first ingredient, not a substitute for it.

Section Four — Uses: official, traditional, and folk, kept apart

Everything in this section stands under two sentences of the Catechism. Sacramentals "do not confer the grace of the Holy Spirit in the way that the sacraments do, but by the Church's prayer, they prepare us to receive grace" (VERIFIED — CCC 1670, Vatican text; the definition at CCC 1667). And: "To attribute the efficacy of prayers or of sacramental signs to their mere external performance, apart from the interior dispositions that they demand, is to fall into superstition" (VERIFIED — CCC 2111, Vatican text). The uses below are sorted into three honest piles: **official** — grounded in the rite's own words or official sources; **traditional** — long-standing practice reported in reputable sources; **folk** — devotional practice with no official standing. A use can be beloved and still be folk. The grade is about its papers, not its worth.

Sprinkling in the home — traditional, with the rite's own sprinkling language behind it. *[Pile label corrected on the falsifier's strike, 2026-11-11: dry-salt home sprinkling rests on reputable secondary and devotional sources, not on an official rubric; the Ritual rubric in evidence concerns holy water.]* Blessed salt "can be sprinkled in and outside the house for protection against evil (e.g. thresholds of doors, foundation of buildings, and in cooking)" (SUPPORTED as a stated proper use — Catholic Answers, "The Uses of Blessed Salt" *[demoted from VERIFIED, falsifier's strike, 2026-11-11]*). "Modest amounts of salt may be sprinkled in one's bedroom, or across thresholds" (SUPPORTED — Hampsch, *Blessed Salt*). Sprinkling "around the perimeter of one's home and property, the perimeter of a child's room, inside vehicles" is reported Catholic custom (SUPPORTED — Association of the Miraculous Medal, National Shrine, Perryville). The specific "four corners" geometry, and sprinkling under the bed, come from devotional instruction, not from any official text — no official text found says "corners" (SUPPORTED as devotional practice — Catholic-Link, "What Catholics Should Know About Blessed Salt"; graded folk-leaning). Walking the whole property line and re-sprinkling

about once a year, presented as instruction from reported visionary messages, is folk practice in the private-revelation lane, and the report itself notes the Church has never required belief in such messages: CANDIDATE (the private-message report carried in devotional circulation, cited in the briefs via the Ronald Smith/Docest copy and the Ephesians-511.net copy — *[attribution unified on the falsifier's strike, 2026-11-11: one underlying report, not two]*). Do not present it as Church teaching.

A pinch in food or drink — official/traditional. The rite itself contemplates eating: the exorcism asks that all who take the salt receive health of soul and body (VERIFIED — *Rituale Romanum* text, Section Two; on the translation of *omnibus sumentibus te*, see the note in the short answer). Use in cooking is a listed proper use (SUPPORTED — Catholic Answers, same article *[demoted from VERIFIED, falsifier's strike, 2026-11-11]*). "A few grains in drinking water or used in cooking or as food seasoning" (SUPPORTED — Hampsch; repeated at the Saint Benedict Center). A mother using blessed salt in bread she bakes for her family is EWTN's own ordinary example of a sacramental in daily life (SUPPORTED — EWTN, "Sacramentals: What Are They?"). Hampsch's further claim that he has "personally witnessed" benefits is his testimony: CANDIDATE as a claim of effect, never Church teaching.

Baths — folk, and not Catholic-sourced. No mention of a blessed-salt bath was found in any Catholic source checked — not in Catholic Answers' list of uses, Hampsch, the Ritual texts, the *Catholic Encyclopedia*, or EWTN: NOT FOUND in Catholic sources. The practice appears in folk and sacred-arts writing and commercial healer pages (CANDIDATE — Milagro Roots Substack; *Spirit of Change* magazine on salt in magic; a commercial shop blog). The Catechism's paragraph on magic condemns such practices "even if this were for the sake of restoring their health" and adds, "Wearing charms is also reprehensible" (VERIFIED — CCC 2117). This dossier lists the bath so Robert has heard of it from us first, graded as what it is.

For the sick — three things that must not be merged. First, sprinkling *the sick with holy water* is in the Roman Ritual's own rubric: the faithful may take holy water home "to sprinkle the sick, their homes, fields, vineyards, and so forth" (VERIFIED — Roman Ritual rubric, reproduced at Catholic Doors). That is holy water, not dry salt alone. Second, blessed salt "intended to be an instrument of grace to preserve one from the corruption of evil occurring as sin, sickness, demonic influence" is a priest-author's pamphlet framing (SUPPORTED — Hampsch), and the saints' stories — St Monagunda, St Columban, St Genevieve healing with blessed salt — are reported tradition (SUPPORTED — Saint Benedict Center, "What Is Blessed Salt?"): the stories' existence is supported; a medical cure is not thereby verified. Using blessed salt in a sick person's food is attested devotional help (SUPPORTED, folk-leaning — FishEaters, "Sick Calls"). Third, and plainly: no official rite directs giving blessed salt to a sick person as a treatment, or in place of medical care: NOT FOUND.

Salt "under the tongue" — a merged claim, unmerged. Salt *in the mouth* is baptismal, and only baptismal: baptismal salt "is given to the catechumen before entering church for baptism" (SUPPORTED — *Catholic Encyclopedia*, "Salt" *[demoted from VERIFIED, falsifier's strike, 2026-11-11]*). *[Struck on the falsifier's strike, 2026-11-11: an earlier sentence repeated Catholic Answers' description of "a few grains placed on the tongue of the person being baptized" as the current optional form. That is an error in that source: no current Roman rite does this — the 1969 children's rite contains no salt at all, and OCIA §89 permits an offering of salt at entrance into the catechumenate, not grains on the tongue in baptism (Section One). The sentence is struck, and the error is recorded here rather than silently removed.]* Augustine's own salt belonged to his becoming a catechumen as a child; his dangerous illness follows in the narrative and is not the reason for the salt (SUPPORTED — Alban Butler's life of Augustine). "Under the tongue," for the sick or for anyone, was NOT FOUND in any official or reputable source searched. A daily grain on the tip of the tongue appears only in low-authority devotional writing: CANDIDATE (*Mary Refuge of Souls*, 2018; Donna-Marie Cooper O'Boyle's

gift-set text). Robert should not carry the second practice dressed in the first one's papers.

Livestock and fields — official for the animal blessing's own prayer; the rest in their own forms. *[Pile label qualified on the falsifier's strike, 2026-11-11.]* A blessing of salt for animals stands in the appendix of the Roman Ritual, with another in honour of St Hubert (SUPPORTED — *Catholic Encyclopedia*, "Salt," 1912 *[demoted from VERIFIED, falsifier's strike, 2026-11-11]; the animal prayer's own text, quoted next, is VERIFIED from the Ritual as printed in the* Rural Life Prayerbook*). The prayer itself, "Blessing of Salt or Feed for Animals," from the Ritual as printed in* The Rural Life Prayerbook *(National Catholic Rural Life Conference, 1956), asks that the animals, "when they have tasted of this, be made free from every sickness and by Your protection be kept from the attacks of the evil spirit" (VERIFIED — text reproduced by EWTN). Sick animals given blessed salt to eat and holy water to drink is medieval practice as summarised in a parish history (SUPPORTED — Penn Church, "Our Church during the Middle Ages"), and St Bernard administering blessed salt in a cattle plague is hagiographic report (SUPPORTED — Saint Benedict Center). Fields are covered officially through holy water sprinkled on "fields, vineyards, and so forth" (VERIFIED — Roman Ritual rubric, above), and field and crop blessings exist in their own right in the* Rural Life Prayerbook* (SUPPORTED). Dry salt scattered directly on a field appears only as a saint's story — Bishop Parthenius and a withered vineyard (SUPPORTED as hagiography — Saint Benedict Center). No official rite for scattering dry blessed salt on fields was found: NOT FOUND.

Carrying a small bottle — traditional custom, with a caution attached. "Carry a small vial of blessed salt while traveling or in your car" (SUPPORTED as devotional recommendation — Catholic-Link). A family custom of little bottles is reported by the Association of the Miraculous Medal: a grandmother who "used to give my siblings and me little bottles of blessed salt… to keep in our rooms or cars" (SUPPORTED — reported family tradition). A small container carried to hotels or a hospital is described in devotional blogging (CANDIDATE — *A Catholic Mom's Life [regraded for consistency on the falsifier's strike, 2026-11-11: a devotional blog is CANDIDATE ground wherever it appears in this dossier]*). No official source directs carrying blessed salt on the person: NOT FOUND. And the caution is official and bears directly here: carrying a bottle *to use somewhere* is transport; carrying it *as a charm whose presence itself protects* runs into the Catechism's word that "wearing charms is also reprehensible" (VERIFIED — CCC 2117). The same caution in pastoral form: sacramentals "are not to be used superstitiously as having self-contained power, but as 'focus-points' funneling one's faith toward Jesus" (SUPPORTED — Hampsch, consistent with CCC 1670 and 2111), and of blessed salt in particular, "it is not a magic weapon — it should be used with reverence and while saying a short prayer" (SUPPORTED — Fatima Center).

In the home of a dying person — NOT FOUND for salt, and the near neighbours recorded so they are not confused with it. No official or reputable source found describes placing or sprinkling blessed salt, as such, in a dying person's home. What is documented: blessed *candles* placed "in the hands of those dying, to keep the Devil at bay" (SUPPORTED — Penn Church history); holy water used in bringing Communion to the sick and in services for the dead (SUPPORTED — Fr. Arthur Tonne, *Talks on the Sacramentals,* 1950, via EWTN); and the sick-call table, where the family sets out a small dish of *ordinary* salt with water, a crucifix, and blessed candles — ordinary, because the priest uses it to absorb anointing oil from his fingertips (SUPPORTED — FishEaters, "Sick Calls"). That dish is not blessed salt, and this dossier does not let the two stand in each other's place.

Giving it away — traditional custom on a VERIFIED principle. No official text prescribes blessed salt as a gift: NOT FOUND as a rite. As custom it is well attested — the Association of the Miraculous Medal offers bottles "for your family's use and to share with loved ones," with members ordering them to "pass down this

tradition" (SUPPORTED); a Fatima Center writer parcelled a parish-blessed container "out to several people in small containers" (SUPPORTED as reported practice). The principle underneath is official: simony is "the buying or selling of spiritual things," under the words "You received without pay, give without pay" (VERIFIED — CCC 2121, quoting Matthew 10:8). Section Five takes up sale and gift in law; here the practice grade is: gifting, traditional and commended; selling, against the principle.

Section Five — The rules that bind Robert personally

Can blessed salt be sold? The honest answer has three layers, and the dossier keeps them separate because popular writing blends them.

The first layer is what canon 1171 actually says: "Sacred objects, which are designated for divine worship by dedication or blessing, are to be treated reverently and are not to be employed for profane or inappropriate use even if they are owned by private persons" (VERIFIED — CIC can. 1171, Vatican text). That is the canon's whole scope. It does not contain the word "sell," and it does not itself forbid sale; its category, in the commentary tradition, is objects designated for divine worship — churches, altars, bells, liturgical vessels. Blessed salt is not, in the theologians' own classification, a can. 1171 object in the strict sense: they distinguish an *intermediate* sort of blessing, "by which things are rendered special instruments of salvation without at the same time becoming irrevocably sacred, such as blessed salt, candles, etc.," from constitutive blessings like those of churches and chalices (SUPPORTED — *Catholic Encyclopedia*, "Blessing"). A diocesan chancellor does read can. 1171 to bar handing such objects over "including buying or selling" — but those words are his gloss, not the canon's (SUPPORTED as interpretation — Benedict Nguyen, Chancellor of the Diocese of Corpus Christi, in *Adoremus*, 12 January 2022).

The second layer is simony, and it is the real wall. "Simony is defined as the buying or selling of spiritual things," under Christ's words, "You received without pay, give without pay" (VERIFIED — CCC 2121; simony is listed among the sins of irreligion at CCC 2118). The distinction the sources draw is between the material thing and the blessing attached to it: "Items may be sold; blessings may not. Any blessed item that is sold should be sold for its intrinsic value apart from the blessing. To sell the blessing itself would amount to simony" (SUPPORTED — Catholic Answers, Jim Blackburn). Traditional moral theology, as summarised from the *Catholic Encyclopedia*'s "Simony" article, finds no simony in selling a thing with something spiritual annexed to it *if the price is not increased on account of the spiritual connection and the Church has not forbidden it* — a consecrated chalice may be sold for what its materials are worth (SUPPORTED — same summary). So an antique rosary sold for its material and historic value is one act; advertising "blessed!" to raise the price is another, and the second is simony on these sources. For Robert's salt the application needs no subtlety: the salt's material value is pennies, and any price charged for it would be a price charged for the blessing. His instinct — "I know I can't sell this stuff" — is right, and now it has its papers: VERIFIED as a principle at CCC 2121, applied to salt by the object/blessing distinction (SUPPORTED — Catholic Answers; *Adoremus*).

Two cautions against overreach, recorded so no one quotes this dossier wrongly. Canon 947 — "any appearance of trafficking or trading is to be excluded entirely from the offering for Masses" — governs Mass stipends only (VERIFIED in scope — CIC cann. 945–958); it is not a general law about blessed objects. And the one *absolute* sale ban in current law is about relics, not salt: "It is absolutely forbidden to sell sacred relics" (VERIFIED — CIC can. 1190 §1). It must not be transferred to rosaries or salt. There is, however, one old and specific prohibition that touches blessed sacramentals directly: a decree of the Sacred Congregation of Indulgences and Sacred Relics (12 July 1847) prohibited selling rosaries and crucifixes and stated that if sold they lose the

blessings and indulgences attached — a prohibition repeated in the *Raccolta* of 1910 and **not** repeated in the current *Manual of Indulgences*, which says only that an indulgence ceases if the article is destroyed or sold; the *Adoremus* analysis states plainly that this "has raised questions as to whether the prohibition is still in force" (SUPPORTED — *Adoremus*, 2022, and the *Catholic Encyclopedia* "Simony" passage). Its prudential conclusion, which is a chancellor's counsel and not a canon: sale of blessed sacramentals is "to be avoided," causes scandal easily, and the clean road is to sell unblessed and bless after sale — or, in Robert's case, simply to give.

Does selling void the blessing? — NOT FOUND as a settled current-law rule about the blessing itself, and the dossier says so rather than repeating the popular sentence. What is actually pinned is narrower, in three pieces. First, about *indulgences*: the current *Manual of Indulgences* states that an indulgence attached to a devotional article ceases if the article is destroyed or sold (VERIFIED — *Manual of Indulgences*, 4th ed. 1999, N16 §2: "An indulgence attached to the use of an article of devotion ceases only if the article is destroyed or sold" *[raised from SUPPORTED on the falsifier's direct read of the Manual, 2026-11-11 — the dossier's one reverse correction]*; Fr. Edward McNamara, EWTN/Zenit, 18 July 2006, citing the same norm in the earlier numbering, and adding the intent test — a genuine charitable donation is not a sale; a "donation" that is really a price is). An indulgence is not a blessing, and the loss of one is not the loss of the other. Second, the historical rule: the 1917 Code provided that blessed or consecrated sacred furnishings lose their blessing if they suffer damage or change so that they lose their former form, **or** if they are used for indecorous uses *or exposed for public sale* (VERIFIED as a historical text — 1917 CIC can. 1305 §1). But the 1917 Code was abrogated by the 1983 Code (can. 6), and "there is no equivalent in the 1983 Code of Canon Law" to its public-sale provision (SUPPORTED — *The Angelus* Q&A on the 1917/1983 comparison). Can. 1305 cannot be cited as current law. Third, a broader assertion exists — "if anything blessed is sold or is severely damaged, it is considered to have lost its blessing" (*Adoremus*/Nguyen, 2022) — but no current canon is quoted for that sentence in his article, so this dossier grades it SUPPORTED as a diocesan chancellor's stated position, not VERIFIED as law; and popular Q&A literature contradicts the blanket form, holding that a sale at material cost preserves the blessing while a sale for profit loses it (CANDIDATE — e.g. YeahCatholic, 2019). The sources disagree in scope. Robert's position is untouched by the disagreement: he is giving the salt away, and on every source in this section, a gift is not a sale.

What does remove a blessing, on pinned texts? Destruction and loss of form, and permanent turning to profane use — stated for sacred *places*: "Sacred places lose their dedication or blessing if they have been destroyed in large part, or have been turned over permanently to profane use by decree of the competent ordinary or in fact" (VERIFIED — CIC can. 1212), with the bishop's formal relegation of a church (VERIFIED — can. 1222) and an altar's loss following can. 1212 (VERIFIED — can. 1238 §1). Those canons concern places and liturgical objects "more precisely" than devotional items, and are only partially of use for small objects (SUPPORTED — McNamara). Substantial change is the working test for vessels: ordinary repair or regilding needs no new blessing; a chalice so damaged that the repaired vessel is "substantially different from the original" would warrant one (SUPPORTED — McNamara, EWTN, 10 October 2021). No formal deconsecration rite or decree procedure for an ordinary devotional object, or for blessed salt, was found: NOT FOUND. Loss for small things is discussed in terms of destruction, loss of form, or profane use — not ceremony. And the Code itself keeps the categories distinct: consecrations and dedications are a class apart from ordinary blessings (VERIFIED — can. 1169 §1 against §2; the archivists' summary of the current books: "dedication" is used only for places, "blessings" for objects, SUPPORTED — ACDA sacred-objects handout, 2014).

Gifting is the lawful road — commended, though not commanded by a canon. "Sacramentals that are useful but no longer desirable should be given away to a parish, person, or place where they may be returned to use," and no blessed sacramental "should ever be sold or purchased" (SUPPORTED — Catholic Answers material adapted in "Giving Sacramentals a Proper Farewell," 2021; the give-away commendation is graded SUPPORTED, the absolute wording being that source's position). Charitable distribution is not a sale, and intent — charity against personal gain — is the deciding test (SUPPORTED — McNamara). The principle underneath is VERIFIED: spiritual goods are received "without payment… give without pay" (CCC 2121). A canon that in terms *commands* gifting blessed objects instead of selling them was NOT FOUND. Gifting is the commended pastoral road in the sources; Robert walks it by instinct, and the sources walk with him.

Disposal. The principle is VERIFIED (can. 1171: reverent treatment, no profane use, even for privately owned objects). The burn-or-bury rule is the traditional application of that principle, not the canon's words: "The basic rule for the disposition of these items is to burn or to bury them… anything that has been blessed should be burned (and then the ashes buried) or simply buried," with non-burnable items destroyed so as to prevent profane re-use and buried, "not disposed of in a landfill" (SUPPORTED — Diocese of Superior guidance, via Relevant Radio, 23 February 2021). Catholic Answers: a blessed object "should not be thrown away but either burned or broken up and the ashes or fragments buried" (SUPPORTED). The USCCB's Secretariat of Divine Worship points the same way for old missals — bury on church grounds, or burn and place the ashes in the ground (SUPPORTED — via EWTN/Zenit, 24 January 2012), and blessed palms "should not be thrown away in the trash… burying them or burning them and spreading the ashes outside," or returning them to the parish (SUPPORTED — Diocese of Baton Rouge). One disagreement is preserved rather than smoothed: the Superior guidance says "it is not a sin to throw away blessed items, but out of proper respect, one should dispose of them in this way," while Baton Rouge's wording calls trash disposal of blessed palms sacrilegious in tone. The practice is agreed; the sin label is not uniform. For blessed salt specifically, no salt-specific disposal rule was found: CANDIDATE by analogy only. Salt is normally *used up* — sprinkled, cooked, given — rather than discarded; any claim that leftover blessed salt must be buried is an extrapolation from the burn-or-bury rule, and is graded as such. Salt-specific rule: NOT FOUND.

Who may use it? Any layperson. Nothing in cann. 1166–1172 restricts the *use* of a blessed sacramental to clergy; canon 1168 restricts *ministry and administration*, a different act (VERIFIED — CIC can. 1166's definition; CCC 1667–1670). Salt-specifically: "The laity are certainly permitted to use exorcized salt or any other Sacramental that the Church has for their disposition" — sprinkled on property and at thresholds, and in cooking, used reverently and prayerfully, "not a magic weapon" (SUPPORTED — Fatima Center, "Blessed Salt: The Forgotten Sacramental"). No source restricting the use of blessed salt to priests or deacons was found: NOT FOUND.

May a layman bless salt himself, with equivalent effect? No — and the dossier shows the working rather than merely asserting the answer. No single canon contains the sentence "a layman cannot bless salt": that literal sentence is NOT FOUND. The conclusion follows from three canons and a Catechism paragraph read together. "The minister of sacramentals is a cleric who has been provided with the requisite power," though lay persons with appropriate qualities may administer **some** sacramentals under the liturgical books and the local ordinary's judgment (VERIFIED — CIC can. 1168). Consecrations and dedications belong to bishops and permitted presbyters; "any presbyter can impart blessings except those reserved"; a deacon only those "expressly permitted by law" — and no paragraph grants lay persons power to impart blessings as ministers of sacramentals (VERIFIED — can. 1169 §§1–3). "In confecting or administering sacramentals, the rites and formulas approved by the authority of the Church are to be observed carefully" (VERIFIED — can. 1167 §2): a

private formula does not confect the Church's sacramental. And the Catechism: "lay people may preside at certain blessings; the more a blessing concerns ecclesial and sacramental life, the more is its administration reserved to the ordained ministry" (VERIFIED — CCC 1669). The *Book of Blessings*' General Introduction (no. 18) lets lay men and women celebrate *certain* blessings "as indicated in the respective orders" — in the commentary tradition, blessings of children, of parents, of students, of boats, prayer at meetings — not the blessing of salt or holy water (SUPPORTED — *Book of Blessings* GI 18, via Catholic Answers and ePriest; Huels in *The Jurist* 65). The distinction underneath is the theologians' own: a *constitutive* blessing, which separates a thing for divine service, is reserved to an ordained minister; *invocative* blessings, which implore God's favour without changing the thing's condition — grace at meals, a parent blessing a child — are the lay sphere (SUPPORTED — *Catholic Encyclopedia*, "Blessing"; McNamara, EWTN, 2 November 2010). The salt rite is presented in the sources as a priest's rite — "Any amount may be presented to a priest for his blessing, using the following official prayer from the Roman Ritual" (SUPPORTED — Hampsch) — and it carries a minor-exorcism element, which is part of why it is not a lay rite; that must not be confused with major exorcism of a possessed person, separately and strictly governed (VERIFIED — CIC can. 1172: special, express permission of the local ordinary, priest only). So: Robert may pray over salt, ask God's blessing on a meal or a home, and bless his children — real invocative blessings under CCC 1669. What he cannot do is confect blessed or exorcised salt as a sacramental of the Church with the standing of salt blessed by a priest using the approved rite. The difference is not sincerity. It is minister and rite.

Section Six — Robert's own salt

This section is Robert's own record. The anonymity fence binds it in full: the priest is "a priest here in Hays," never named, and no parish is named — here as everywhere in the dossier.

On 17 October 2026, a priest here in Hays came to Robert's apartment building and exorcised one pound of Robert's salt. Robert had brought six pounds; the priest exorcised one and declined the other five. He used the old rite — the prayers of Section Two — in their old order: the exorcism of the salt first, then its blessing. *[Clarification added on the falsifier's note, 2026-11-11, so no reader imports a verdict this dossier has not graded: Section Two records the 2021* Responsa ad dubia *position and McNamara's application of it to blessings; the* Responsa*'s question is in terms about celebrating sacraments with the pre-reform* Rituale*, and the dossier preserves McNamara's own caveat on that point. No liceity verdict about this 2026 home blessing follows either way from the dossier's own evidence, and none is given.]* Robert was present and watched him work, and his own verdict on the man stands on the house record in Robert's words: "a very careful priest," whose youthful appearance is not to be mistaken for carelessness.

The priest's teaching, as Robert reported it the same day, is recorded here in full because the rest of this section hangs on it. The exorcism is of the salt only — nothing else was being exorcised. The salt is a powerful sacramental, meant for individual use. A pinch of it, flicked into the corners and along the inside perimeter of the apartment, suffices. Sprinkling some around the building's perimeter was conceded when Robert pressed the question, and the priest answered his further questions — about a hospital several blocks away, and about whether a line of salt must be continuous — patiently, one by one. A little of the salt may go in food, if Robert insists. And sacramentals are to be used reverently, here and there — the priest gently corrected Robert's earlier habit of drinking newly blessed water down at a draught: "let's not do that no more."

Robert's current practice stands on that record. The labelled bag lives in his cupboard; he lays a food product or candy on top of the bag so it takes a little of the blessing, and he uses the salt by pinching and sprinkling. *[Dated*

note on the falsifier's strike, 2026-11-11: the act is Robert's and is recorded as his; the claimed mechanism — a blessing passing by contact from the bag to an object laid on it — is graded CANDIDATE/NOT FOUND. No source found supports blessing-by-contact-transfer; it is a weaker claim than the mixing question Section Seven grades NOT FOUND for salt, and it sits against the dossier's own frame that sacramentals work by the Church's prayer, not by a transferable charge (VERIFIED — CCC 1670), with the superstition caution at CCC 2111 attached. The desk's counsel, recorded beside the practice rather than over it: if the candy is to carry the gift, put a few grains of the salt itself with it, which is the attested practice (SUPPORTED — Section Four), rather than relying on contact.] On the evening this dossier was commissioned, 11 November 2026, he was bagging measured portions of it to **give** — never sell — to people at a communion service, each portion labelled with the date and the fact of its blessing. That practice was checked against Section Five as the dossier was built: giving is the commended road on every source found (SUPPORTED — Catholic Answers material; McNamara's intent test), and there is no official "proper amount" for the portion (NOT FOUND, Section Seven), so his measured little bags sit squarely inside customary practice (SUPPORTED — small containers for giving, Association of the Miraculous Medal; Fatima Center).

His open puzzle, left with him since 17 October and restated here in his own framing, is the gap between the salt's power against demons — the exorcism of Section Two adjures every unclean spirit to flee the place where it is sprinkled — and the priest's small-measure, defensive framing of its use. The dossier was not commissioned to close that puzzle, and it does not pretend to. But the evidence gathered does bear on it, and the bearing is this, stated as the desk's reading of the record rather than as a verdict over it. The small measure is not one careful priest's private caution; it is the tradition's measure at every point the scouts could check. The catechumen's portion in the fourth century was a taste (SUPPORTED as inference *[demoted on the falsifier's strike, 2026-11-11: neither Carthage 397, which speaks only of the "custom of salt," nor Augustine's "seasoned with his salt" states an amount or a tasting; the taste —* degustatio salis *— is documented from John the Deacon and the later baptismal rite, Sections One and Two]*). The Ritual's own sprinkling language is of pinches and places touched. The modern devotional sources say "modest amounts," "a few grains," "small amounts" (SUPPORTED — Hampsch; Fatima Center; Catholic Answers). And the theology underneath the practice explains why quantity is the wrong dial: sacramentals work "by the Church's prayer," preparing a person to receive grace, not by a power stored in the material (VERIFIED — CCC 1670), and their efficacy hangs on "the faith and devotion of the person using" them (SUPPORTED — Hampsch). On that theology, a pinch is not a homeopathic dilution of a stronger dose. There is no stronger dose. The priest's framing and the exorcism's boldness are the same doctrine seen from its two ends: the prayer is maximal, because it is the Church praying; the measure is minimal, because the salt was never the engine. Robert may still hold the puzzle open — it is his — but the record gives him the tradition's own answer to weigh against it.

One more piece of his record belongs here, because he asked about it while bagging: the label. The abbreviation of "Father" in church notes is **Fr.**, not "Ft." — and for the gift portions the label that answers every question by itself, under his own anonymity ruling of 2026-11-02 (the priest is never named in anything public about this salt; publicly it was "blessed by a priest"), is the full form he settled on in November: **"Exorcised and blessed salt"** with the date — the old rite prayed both prayers over this salt, exorcism first, so the fuller label is also the more accurate one (the wording question is graded at the house record of 2026-11-01: "blessed salt" for everyday use, "exorcised and blessed salt" for full precision).

Section Seven — The practical questions

Does blessed salt expire? No time limit was found in any source. Blessed things "retain their blessing so long as they remain whole, unbroken, integral, and are recognizable as what they were when they were blessed" (SUPPORTED — Adoremus, *Rite Questions*, 2023). Salt-specifically, one priest's pastoral answer: salt "is really stable, so it will endure as long as it is not diluted by water, etc." (SUPPORTED as one priest's opinion — Fr. John Zuhlsdorf, *ASK FATHER*). The documented loss-triggers are destruction or loss of form and unfitness for use, and indecorous or profane use — stated in the 1917 Code for sacred furnishings (VERIFIED as a historical text — 1917 CIC can. 1305 §1) and for sacred places in the current Code (VERIFIED — CIC can. 1212) — and, in the 1917 discipline and the sacramentals tradition, sale; a direct, salt-specific canon on sale is NOT FOUND, and its application to salt is analogy, CANDIDATE. As kitchen fact, plain salt itself does not expire and lasts indefinitely in cool, dry conditions (SUPPORTED — USDA guidance via *Reader's Digest*).

If blessed salt is mixed into a larger quantity of plain salt, is the whole blessed? The sources do not settle this for salt: NOT FOUND. No Catholic source found states a salt-into-salt rule in either direction. The famous principle belongs to water, and the dossier gives it in its own domain so Robert can see exactly what is and is not his. The 1917 Code allowed unblessed water to be mixed into diminished baptismal water, "even repeatedly, but in smaller quantity" — *minore tamen copia* (VERIFIED — 1917 CIC can. 757 §2, Latin quoted in Mahoney, *Questions and Answers*). Custom extends the same "less than half" rule to ordinary holy water, but the custom is "not officially recognized" (SUPPORTED — *Homiletic & Pastoral Review*, June 2022, citing Catholic Answers and Theiler, 1909), the reverse plainly does not work — "adding a thimble of holy water to a gallon of regular water does not make the container full of holy water" (SUPPORTED — same source) — and a careful modern treatment warns the adding rule "appears only to be in the case of baptismal water" and recommends simply obtaining newly blessed water (SUPPORTED — Adoremus, 2023); one priest states the top-up practice "isn't forbidden. Neither is it recommended," and says he would not do it (SUPPORTED as opinion — Zuhlsdorf, 2018). Applied to salt, all of that is analogy only: CANDIDATE. The practical consequence for Robert is plain and is stated as counsel, not law: do not stretch the pound by folding it into a bigger bag and calling the whole blessed. Keep the pound whole, use it as it is — and if more is ever wanted, the sourced road is open: "Any amount may be presented to a priest for his blessing" (SUPPORTED — Hampsch).

What if it gets wet, clumps, or dissolves? A direct ruling on wet or clumped blessed salt was NOT FOUND; no source found says clumping or damp, by itself, removes or preserves the blessing. Dissolving, by contrast, is a prescribed use, not a loss: blessed salt is ordered to be mixed into water for holy water and for the Pontifical's church-consecration mixture (VERIFIED — *Catholic Encyclopedia*, "Salt," 1912; SUPPORTED — Hampsch). One priest's limit-word — salt endures "as long as it is not diluted by water" (SUPPORTED as opinion — Zuhlsdorf) — names dilution as a limit but issues no ruling that dissolved salt is unblessed, and the Ritual's own holy-water use cuts the other way. A general corruption principle exists — blessed elements that "are corrupted and they cease to be what they were (wine turns to vinegar, etc.)… stop being blessed" (SUPPORTED — Zuhlsdorf) — but whether dissolved salt has "ceased to be" salt is not addressed there. Clumping itself is a kitchen fact: salt is hygroscopic and moisture clumps it, with no theological consequence stated in any source found (SUPPORTED as kitchen fact — USDA via *Reader's Digest*). Bottom line, stated as the sources leave it: the wet/clumped/dissolved question for salt kept as salt is unsettled; dissolving it into holy water is its intended liturgical use.

How much is a proper measure? No rubric, canon, or official source specifies a quantity for sprinkling a room or a home, or for a gift: NOT FOUND as a rule. The customary picture is consistent across devotional sources: "modest amounts… sprinkled in one's bedroom, or across thresholds… a few grains in drinking water or used in

cooking" (SUPPORTED — Hampsch); "the laity can sprinkle the blessed salt in small amounts on their property… at the threshold of their door" (SUPPORTED — Fatima Center); "a small pinch of blessed salt to your family's food when cooking" is lay devotional practice, CANDIDATE as a sourced norm (*A Catholic Mom's Life*). A recommendation to re-sprinkle about once a year rests on the weakest source in this section, a devotional report repeating private messages: CANDIDATE (Ephesians-511.net report), not Church teaching. Gift-bottle sizes are packaging practice, not norm: one shrine offers blessed and exorcised salt in a six-ounce bottle and in one-ounce bottle sets (SUPPORTED as practice — Association of the Miraculous Medal), and the Fatima Center writer parcelled a 26-ounce container into small containers for several people (SUPPORTED as reported practice). Robert's measured portions, whatever small size he bags them at, stand inside that customary range; there is no figure to be wrong against.

Storage. Two grounds, kept apart. Reverence: sacred objects designated for divine worship by dedication or blessing "are to be treated reverently" (VERIFIED — CIC can. 1171, Vatican text; note the citation is the *Code*, can. 1171 — CCC 1171 is a different paragraph, about the liturgical year). The canon's strict category is objects set apart for divine worship, so reverent handling of household blessed salt is that norm applied by extension: SUPPORTED (Adoremus/Nguyen analysis, 2022 *[surname spelling corrected on the falsifier's strike, 2026-11-11]*). Practice: "It is recommended to keep it in a separate container marked as 'Blessed Salt' so as not to mix it up with the other salt in the home" (SUPPORTED — Fatima Center). Keep it dry and sealed as kitchen practicality — pure salt lasts indefinitely in cool, dry conditions (SUPPORTED — USDA via *Reader's Digest*). An official home-storage rule for blessed salt — a prescribed place, vessel, or separation beyond labelling — was NOT FOUND. Robert's labelled bag in the cupboard already meets everything the sources actually ask.

Can it be re-blessed, or used again without a new blessing? Used again: yes. "Both baptismal salt and blessed salt may be used again without a new benediction" (SUPPORTED — *Catholic Encyclopedia*, "Salt," 1912; the quotation itself is verbatim, as the falsifier confirmed, 2026-11-11 — the grade is SUPPORTED because the Encyclopedia is a secondary source *[demoted from VERIFIED, falsifier's strike, 2026-11-11]*). Re-blessed: no prohibition was found — NOT FOUND as a prohibition — and no authoritative source requires re-blessing of salt that has simply been kept and reused. A low-authority pastoral answer holds there is "no reason to have an item blessed again, under normal circumstances, unless the item has been defiled or corrupted" (CANDIDATE — Bro. Ignatius, Ephesians-511.net Q&A). Re-blessing becomes a live question only if one first accepts, by the analogy flagged above, that a loss-trigger has occurred — objects that lost their blessing through public sale "do need to be re-blessed" in the 1917-discipline discussion (SUPPORTED for the objects that source discusses — *The Angelus* Q&A, 2000; CANDIDATE for salt specifically).

The honest gaps, stated once. Salt-specific rules on (i) sale causing loss of blessing, (ii) mixing blessed salt into plain salt, and (iii) wet, clumped, or dissolved salt kept as salt: the sources do not settle these for salt. The answers above are the documented water, sacramentals, and sacred-furnishings rules, with the analogy flagged each time rather than hidden. No official amount, no official home-storage rule, and no expiry period for blessed salt were found in any source searched: NOT FOUND on all three.

Sources relied on, by name

Scripture as cited by book, chapter, and verse (Bible Gateway / BibleHub reproductions). Council of Carthage (397), Acts, CCSL 249 (Munier ed.), Pearse translation. Augustine, *Confessions* I.11 (Loeb); *De peccatorum meritis* II.26 (NPNF). John the Deacon, *Letter to Senarius* (PL 59). Old Gelasian Sacramentary (Reg. lat. 316; Wilson 1894; Mohlberg 1960). *Rituale Romanum* (1614/1952/1962 forms): *Ordo ad faciendam aquam*

benedictam, *Ordo Baptismi*; texts at 1962ordo.today, preces-latinae.org, Catholic Doors; Weller translation. *Collectio Rituum* (1954); *Excerpta e Rituali Romano* (1961). *Ordo Baptismi Parvulorum* decree (1969); *Ordo Initiationis Christianae Adultorum* §89 (1972). *Book of Blessings* / *De Benedictionibus* (1984; U.S. 1989), nos. 1388–1400, 1781–1804, GI 18. *Roman Missal*, 3rd ed., Appendix II. *Responsa ad dubia* on *Traditionis Custodes*, Dicastery for Divine Worship, 4 Dec. 2021. Code of Canon Law (1983), cann. 1166–1172, 1190, 1212, 1222, 1238; Code of Canon Law (1917), cann. 757 §2, 1305 §1. Catechism of the Catholic Church, 1667–1672, 2110–2111, 2117–2118, 2121. *Manual of Indulgences*, N16 §2. *Catholic Encyclopedia* (1912), "Salt," "Blessing," "Simony," "Holy Water." Fr. Edward McNamara, ZENIT/EWTN columns, 2006–2026. Benedict Nguyen (Chancellor, Diocese of Corpus Christi), *Adoremus*, 2022; *Adoremus*, *Rite Questions*, 2023. Catholic Answers, "The Uses of Blessed Salt" and Q&As. Rev. John H. Hampsch, *Blessed Salt & Sacramentals*. Fatima Center, "Blessed Salt: The Forgotten Sacramental." Association of the Miraculous Medal (Perryville). Saint Benedict Center, "What Is Blessed Salt?" *The Rural Life Prayerbook* (1956), via EWTN. Diocese of Superior guidance via Relevant Radio (2021); Diocese of Baton Rouge palms Q&A; USCCB Secretariat of Divine Worship via EWTN (2012). *Homiletic & Pastoral Review* (2022); *The Angelus* Q&As (2000); Fr. John Zuhlsdorf, *ASK FATHER* columns. Johnson, *The Rites of Christian Initiation*; Lupi, *The Development of the Rite of Baptism*; Van Slyke, *Antiphon* 8:2 (2003); Turner (2019). Devotional and folk sources are named in place where they are used, and graded as such.

Appendix — Verification record: the falsifier's pass (2026-11-11)

The falsifier read this dossier in full and spot-checked its load-bearing quotations against primary texts on the web (Vatican CIC and CCC, the 1917 Code, the 1969 decree, the OCIA Latin, the *Collectio Rituum* of 1954, the *Manual of Indulgences*, the *Responsa ad dubia*, the *Catholic Encyclopedia*, the *Adoremus* articles in full, and the EWTN *Rural Life Prayerbook* reproduction). Its bottom line, in its own summary: **no anonymity breach; no fabricated quotations found — every named spot-check's wording survived.** The corrections needed were grading corrections, one strike, one unflagged folk practice, the short answer's two flattened claims, and four minor wording fixes. Each is recorded below with its disposition; every correction in the body was made by dated note at the point of the claim, and nothing in this dossier was silently rewritten.

Anonymity fence: PASS. A full-text search found no name and no parish for the priest who blessed Robert's salt, anywhere in the file. He appears only as "a priest" / "a priest here in Hays." The names present are public source-authors in their source roles, plus source dioceses and a shrine, none of them Robert's priest or parish.

What survived checking, named: CIC can. 1171 verbatim, with the dossier's scope reading confirmed (no word "sell" in the canon; Chancellor Nguyen's "including buying or selling" is his gloss). CCC 2121, 2118, 1669, 1670, 2111, and 2117 verbatim. CIC cann. 1167 §2, 1168, 1169 (subject to strike 9a), 1172, 1190 §1, 1212, 1222, 1238 §1, and can. 947's Mass-stipend-only scope. The *Commixtio* correction: the *Collectio Rituum* (1954) confirms the rubric and the formula with *fiat* at the end; *"Fiat commixtio…"* was not found. Carthage 397 in substance (*nisi solitum salis*), with the canon-numbering variance real. The 1969 decree dates (15 May 1969; use from 8 September 1969) and OCIA §89's Latin, exact. 1917 can. 1305 §1 and can. 757 §2, with the dossier's scope cautions standing. The *Catholic Encyclopedia* reuse line verbatim (its grade fell; the quotation stands). The *Catholic Encyclopedia* "Blessing" intermediate-blessing passage; the *Roman Missal* Appendix II salt prayer and its silent-pouring rubric; *Book of Blessings* nos. 1781 ff.; the 2021 *Responsa* (Negative; only the 1952 *Rituale*, only to canonically erected personal parishes); Augustine, *Confessions* I.11 and *De peccatorum meritis* II.26 (II.42 in some editions); Hampsch's "modest amounts… a few grains… Any amount may be presented to a priest"; the *Adoremus Rite Questions* (2023) "whole, unbroken, integral, and recognizable" line;

and the *Rural Life Prayerbook* animal-blessing prayer, exact.

The strikes, and what was done about each (all dispositions dated 2026-11-11):

1. **Catholic Answers graded VERIFIED where it stood alone — DEMOTED to SUPPORTED throughout.** Catholic Answers is a reputable secondary source, not a primary text; grading it VERIFIED while grading Hampsch SUPPORTED for the same kind of checking was the dossier's largest grading defect. Applied at the short answer and in Section Four (home sprinkling, cooking, the baptismal-tongue passage). 2. **The 1912 Catholic Encyclopedia graded VERIFIED where it stood alone — DEMOTED to SUPPORTED throughout**, including the reuse line, the appendix animal blessings, the catechumen passage, and the holy-water history in the short answer. Its quotations are verbatim; its grade is now honest about its class. 3. **Catholic Answers' "current optional form" of baptismal salt on the tongue — STRUCK.** No current Roman rite does this; Section One's own record (1969; OCIA §89) refutes it. The sentence was struck in Section Four and the error recorded in place, in the same breath. 4. **The candy-on-the-bag practice in Section Six recorded ungraded — FLAGGED in place.** Blessing by contact transfer is graded CANDIDATE/NOT FOUND, with the CCC 2111 caution attached and the desk's counsel recorded beside the practice: put grains of the salt itself with the gift, which is the attested practice. 5. **The short answer's two flattened claims — QUALIFIED in place.** "The blessing does not expire" now reads "does not expire by time," with the loss-triggers named; the confecting sentence now states that it is an inference from three canons, the literal sentence being NOT FOUND. 6. **Section Six's "the catechumen's portion was a taste (VERIFIED)" — DEMOTED to SUPPORTED as inference**, with the taste cited to John the Deacon and the later rite, where it is documented. 7. **Section Four's pile labels — CORRECTED.** Home sprinkling is now headed "traditional," and the livestock heading is qualified; "official" is kept only where a rite text carries it (the animal prayer's own words). 8. **Inconsistent grading of devotional sources — UNIFIED.** *A Catholic Mom's Life* is CANDIDATE wherever it appears; the yearly re-sprinkle's two attributions were unified as one underlying private-message report; the short answer's bottle sizes are now attributed to the Association of the Miraculous Medal alone. The Fatima Center's normative-sounding lines are recorded here as resting on a devotional outlet: the dossier's counsel stands on CCC 2121 and the canons, not on that outlet, and its labelling advice is practice, not law. 9. **Four minor wording fixes — APPLIED and recorded:** (a) Section Two's can. 1169 quotation now matches the Vatican text ("Any presbyter…"); (b) "Nuyen" corrected to "Nguyen" in Section Seven; (c) Section One's "in force in its 1962 edition" corrected — the *Rituale*'s last typical edition is 1952; (d) the *omnibus sumentibus te* rendering is now standardised with its translations named. 10. **Section Two's closing practical claim — REGRADED as inference (SUPPORTED).** Two rite texts establish what the rites contain, not what most parishes do. 11. **Section Two against Section Six — CLARIFIED in Section Six.** A note there states that no liceity verdict about the 2026 home blessing follows either way from the dossier's evidence, and none is given. 12. **One reverse correction — RAISED.** The *Manual of Indulgences* N16 §2 line was graded SUPPORTED via *Adoremus*; the falsifier read the Manual directly (4th ed. 1999) and confirmed it verbatim. It now stands VERIFIED in Section Five — the dossier's one upgrade, recorded like every downgrade.

The falsifier's closing verdict on consistency: the Section Four/Five separations the desk worried about are, in the body, honestly kept — sale is not loss of blessing; indulgence-loss is not blessing-loss; the holy-water mixing rule is not a salt rule; expiry as a period is NOT FOUND. The failures were concentrated where the falsifier found them: the short answer, one baptismal parenthetical, and one unflagged practice in Section Six. All three are corrected above, in place, with the original error named.

End of dossier. Public edition — 11 November 2026.